engagements the Allies withstood the initial Japanese onslaught and were able to coax the Japanese into fighting a battle of attrition. Unable to secure provisions at Imphal the Japanese were faced with the prospect of fighting a prolonged campaign with an extended supply line through the dense Burmese jungles.

After Imphal was attacked, a near-simultaneous attack on Kohima began. On April 5, 1944, the Japanese 31st Division attacked Kohima ridge. Initially, the First Assam Regiment set up defensive positions east of Kohima before being forced withdraw to more isolated positions along Kohima ridge. Reinforcements from 161st Indian Brigade, Fifth Indian Division, and the Fourth Royal West Kents took up defensive positions in and around Kohima. On April 7, 1944, additional Allied reinforcements arrived from Jotsoma. The Allies were able to contain initial Japanese advances and combat turned into a stalemate. The Japanese laid siege to Kohima beginning April 8, 1944, forcing the Allies to supply the defenders by air. On April 10, 1944, the Japanese were able to force the Kohima garrison to withdraw. By April 13, 1944, the Japanese sought to press their advantage against Allied positions by attacking positions along the Kohima ridge. The attack was eventually repulsed by British artillery from Jotsoma. The next day the Japanese responded with artillery barrages against Kohima and Jotsoma garrisons but withheld launching a ground offensive. The failure to launch a ground attack gave the British 2nd Division time to arrive on April 15, 1944, after breaking the Japanese roadblock on the Dimapur-Kohima Road. The arrival of fresh troops relieved the beleaguered Indian 161st Brigade. The Japanese launched a final desperate assault on the evening of April 16, 1944. Heavy fighting ensued.

By May 1, 1944, Indian troops stabilized their lines and were reinforced by the 33rd Brigade of the Indian 7th Division on May 4, 1944. Although the Japanese lines were tough to break down, their supply situation had become critical. The situation took a turn for the worse on May 12, 1944, when the Indian 114th Brigade arrived. The XXXIII Corps attacked southward from Kohima toward Imphal. Japanese troops fought back against the British and Indian attack. Nevertheless, the Japanese troops were driven from area surrounding Kohima at the end of May. By May 25, 1944, the Japanese troops were short of both food and supplies. On May 31, 1944, Japanese troops withdrew from Naga Hills.